point it would have been possible to negotiate an agreement more in line with the suggestions of the Indian government and E.G. Browne's five point plan, and potentially save Anglo-Persian relations from sinking any further. Instead, after 1920 the foreign secretary commenced on what can only be described as a monumental sulk towards Persia. In January 1921, the Persian government was still obfuscating when it came to ratifying the agreement with Britain. When Norman enquired as to the possibility of modifying the agreement to make it more palatable to the Persian public, George Churchill of the Foreign Office noted quite plainly that such action seemed pointless.[8] Curzon made clear his position a few days later when he explained to Norman that he was now 'wholly indifferent as to whether [the] Medjliss is summoned or not'. The time for submitting the agreement had passed six weeks ago and now Britain's only interest was that a decent government be formed for Persia's own sake.[9] When Norman further suggested annulling the current agreement and creating another to replace it Curzon responded:

I have no desire to negotiate a new agreement...Personally I will never propose another agreement with the Persians. Not unless they came on their knees would I even consider any application from them...In future we will look after our own interests in Persia not hers.[10]

The bitterness in Curzon's reply is palpable. Having invested so much of his time, energy and reputation in the Persian agreement, the failure of the Tehran government to ratify the document had apparently resulted in the foreign secretary washing his hands of the entire matter.

Although it was not interested in negotiating an amended or entirely new agreement with the Persian government, neither did the British government have the 'slightest intention of denouncing the agreement themselves and of accepting thereby the responsibility for a proceeding the blame of which must rest exclusively upon Persian shoulders'.[11] For Curzon, it no doubt seemed that denouncing the agreement amounted to admitting that it had been wrong to create it in the first place. In Norman's opinion, such